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United States Patent	12412966
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 09, 2025
Inventor(s)	Kato; Masashi et al.

Power storage device

Abstract

A power storage device includes power storage cells and a bus bar. Each power storage cell includes positive-electrode sheets, negative-electrode sheets, a positive-electrode current collector plate, a negative-electrode current collector plate, and a laminated film. The positive-electrode current collector plate includes a positive-electrode protrusion shaped to protrude from the laminated film, and the negative-electrode current collector plate includes a negative-electrode protrusion shaped to protrude from the laminated film. The power storage cells are stacked such that the positive electrode protrusion in one power storage cell and the negative-electrode protrusion in another power storage cell adjacent to the one power storage cell face each other in the one direction. The bus bar is shaped to extend in the one direction and connects the positive-electrode protrusion to the negative-electrode protrusion.

Inventors: Kato; Masashi (Konan, JP), Matsumoto; Mizuho (Toyota, JP), Nakayama; Hiroyuki (Okazaki, JP), Maeda; Daiki (Toyota, JP)

Applicant: TOYOTA JIDOSHA KABUSHIKI KAISHA (Toyota, JP)

Family ID: 80446123

Assignee: TOYOTA JIDOSHA KABUSHIKI KAISHA (Toyota, JP)

Appl. No.: 17/688038

Filed: March 07, 2022

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20220320693 A1	Oct. 06, 2022

Foreign Application Priority Data

JP	2021-060593	Mar. 31, 2021
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Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: H01M10/0585 (20100101); H01M10/0525 (20100101); H01M50/505 (20210101); H01M50/54 (20210101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC H01M50/54 (20210101); H01M10/0525 (20130101); H01M10/0585 (20130101); H01M50/505 (20210101);

Field of Classification Search

CPC: H01M (50/54); H01M (10/0525); H01M (10/0585); H01M (50/505); H01M (50/124); H01M (50/178); H01M (50/503); H01M (50/51); H01M (50/548); H01M (50/553); H01M (50/507); H01M (50/533); H01M (50/249); H01M (50/502); H01M (50/547); H01M (50/557); H01M (2220/20)

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Primary Examiner: Legette; Tiffany

Assistant Examiner: Macaluso; Ignazio

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Sughrue Mion, PLLC

Background/Summary

(1) This nonprovisional application is based on Japanese Patent Application No. 2021-060593 filed on Mar. 31, 2021 with the Japan Patent Office, the entire contents of which are hereby incorporated by reference.

BACKGROUND

Field

(2) The present disclosure relates to a power storage device.

Description of the Background Art

(3) A power storage device including a plurality of power storage cells has conventionally been known. For example, Japanese Patent Laying-Open No. 2005-190885 discloses a laminated battery module including a plurality of lithium-ion batteries. Each of a pair of terminals of a lithium-ion battery includes an extension extending from a power generation element in one direction and a protrusion protruding laterally from the extension. The protrusions of the opposite terminals of a lithium-ion battery are bent in the opposite directions, so that a bent portion of a positive-electrode terminal is connected to a bent portion of a negative-electrode terminal of an adjacent lithium-ion battery in one side, and a bent portion of a negative-electrode terminal is connected to a bent portion of a positive-electrode terminal of an adjacent lithium-ion battery on the opposite side.

SUMMARY

(4) In the laminated battery module disclosed in Japanese Patent Laying-Open No. 2005-190885, as the thickness (the number of stacked layers of an electrode body) of each power storage cell changes in accordance with, for example, a change in required output, the shape of the terminal (current collector plate) changes as well. It is thus required to prepare current collector plates having shapes varying in accordance with the thicknesses of the power storage cells. This results in cost increase.

(5) An object of the present disclosure is to provide a power storage device that can accommodate changes in the thickness of each power storage cell while providing commonality of shape among current collector plates.

(6) A power storage device according to an aspect of the present disclosure includes a plurality of power storage cells stacked in one direction, and a bus bar that electrically connects power storage cells of the plurality of power storage cells to each other. Each of the power storage cells includes a plurality of positive-electrode sheets stacked in the one direction, a plurality of negative-electrode sheets stacked in the one direction, a positive-electrode current collector plate connected to the plurality of positive-electrode sheets, a negative-electrode current collector plate connected to the plurality of negative-electrode sheets, and a laminated film covering the plurality of positive-electrode sheets, the plurality of negative-electrode sheets, a part of the positive-electrode current collector plate, and a part of the negative-electrode current collector plate. The positive-electrode current collector plate includes a positive-electrode protrusion shaped to protrude from the laminated film in an orthogonal direction orthogonal to the one direction. The negative-electrode current collector plate includes a negative-electrode protrusion shaped to protrude from the laminated film in the orthogonal direction. The plurality of power storage cells are stacked such that the positive-electrode protrusion in one power storage cell among the plurality of power storage cells and the negative-electrode protrusion in another power storage cell adjacent to the one power storage cell among the plurality of power storage cells face each other in the one direction. The bus bar is shaped to extend in the one direction and connects the positive-electrode protrusion to the negative-electrode protrusion.

(7) The foregoing and other objects, features, aspects and advantages of the present disclosure will become more apparent from the following detailed description of the present disclosure when taken in conjunction with the accompanying drawings.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 is a perspective view schematically showing a configuration of a battery pack including a power storage device of Embodiment 1 of the present disclosure.
- (2) FIG. 2 is a sectional view taken along the line II-II in FIG. 1.
- (3) FIG. 3 is an exploded perspective view schematically showing a configuration of a power storage module.
- (4) FIG. 4 is a sectional view schematically showing a configuration of a battery pack including a power storage device of Embodiment 2 of the present disclosure.
- (5) FIG. 5 is an exploded perspective view schematically showing a configuration of a power storage module in the power storage device of Embodiment 2 of the present disclosure.
- (6) FIG. 6 is a sectional view schematically showing a configuration of a battery pack including a power storage device of Embodiment 3 of the present disclosure.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PREFERRED EMBODIMENTS

(7) Embodiments of the present disclosure will be described with reference to the drawings. The same or corresponding elements in the drawings have the same reference characters allotted in the figures referenced below.

Embodiment 1

- (8) FIG. 1 is a perspective view schematically showing a configuration of a battery pack including a power storage device of Embodiment 1 of the present disclosure. FIG. 2 is a sectional view taken along the line II-II in FIG. 1. A battery pack 1 is mounted on, for example, an electric-powered vehicle such as a battery electric vehicle.
- (9) As shown in FIGS. 1 and 2, battery pack 1 includes a power storage device 10 and a cooling device 20. Cooling device 20 is a device that cools power storage device 10. Cooling device 20 is placed to be in contact with a lateral portion of power storage device 10. As shown in FIG. 1, cooling device 20 is configured to allow a cooling medium (such as water) C to flow therein. FIG. 1 shows a state in which a part of cooling device 20 is missing.
- (10) As shown in FIG. 1, power storage device 10 includes a pair of external terminals 11, 12. External terminal 11 is a positive-electrode terminal, and external terminal 12 is a negative-electrode terminal. As shown in FIG. 2, power storage device 10 includes a power storage module 100, a case 200, an insulating sheet 300, and a filling portion 400.
- (11) FIG. 3 is an exploded perspective view schematically showing a configuration of a power storage module. As shown in FIGS. 2 and 3, power storage module 100 includes at least one power storage cell 101 and a plurality of bus bars 102.
- (12) In the present embodiment, power storage module 100 includes a plurality of power storage cells 101. Power storage cells 101 are stacked in one direction (the vertical direction in FIG. 1). Although FIGS. 2 and 3 show three power storage cells 101, the number of power storage cells 101 is not particularly limited. An example of power storage cell 101 is a lithium ion battery.
- (13) Power storage cell 101 is a so-called laminate-type cell. Specifically, power storage cell 101 includes a plurality of electrode bodies 110, a current collector plate 120, a laminated film 130, an adhesive member 140, and an electrolyte solution (not shown). Power storage cell 101 may be formed of an all-solid-state battery having a solid electrolyte in place of a separator and an electrolyte solution.
- (14) Electrode bodies 110 are stacked in one direction. Each of electrode bodies 110 includes a positive-electrode sheet 111, a negative-electrode sheet 112, and a separator 113 placed between positive-electrode sheet 111 and negative-electrode sheet 112. An end of positive-electrode sheet 111 and an end of negative-electrode sheet 112 are electrically connected to current collector plate 120.

(15) Current collector plate **120** includes a positive-electrode current collector plate **120p** connected with each positive-electrode sheet **111**, and a negative-electrode current collector plate **120n** connected with each negative-electrode sheet **112**.

(16) Positive-electrode current collector plate **120p** is placed on one side of each sheet **111**, **112** in an orthogonal direction orthogonal to a direction of stacking of positive-electrode sheets **111** and negative-electrode sheets **112** (the one direction). In the present embodiment, positive-electrode current collector plate **120p** is shaped into a flat plate. Positive-electrode current collector plate **120p** is made of, for example, aluminum. Positive-electrode current collector plate **120p** includes a positive-electrode protrusion **121** shaped to protrude from laminated film **130** toward one side in the orthogonal direction.

(17) Negative-electrode current collector plate **120n** is placed on the other side of each sheet **111**, **112** in the orthogonal direction. In the present embodiment, negative-electrode current collector plate **120n** is shaped into a flat plate. Negative-electrode current collector plate **120n** is made of, for example, copper. Negative-electrode current collector plate **120n** includes a negative-electrode protrusion **122** shaped to protrude from laminated film **130** toward the other side in the orthogonal direction. Negative-electrode current collector plate **120n** may be placed on the same side as the side on which positive-electrode current collector plate **120p** is placed. In this case, negative-electrode current collector plate **120n** is placed at a position at which negative-electrode current collector plate **120n** is adjacent to positive-electrode current collector plate **120p** in a direction orthogonal to both of the one direction and the orthogonal direction.

(18) As shown in FIG. 2, power storage cells **101** are stacked such that positive-electrode protrusion **121** in one power storage cell **101** and negative-electrode protrusion **122** in power storage cell **101** adjacent to the one power storage cell **101** face each other in the one direction.

(19) As shown in FIG. 3, positive-electrode protrusion **121** of power storage cell **101** placed at an end on one side in a direction is connected with a bus bar **13** provided with external terminal **11**, and negative-electrode protrusion **122** of power storage cell **101** placed at an end on the other side in the direction is connected with a bus bar **14** provided with external terminal **12**.

(20) Laminated film **130** covers electrode bodies **110** and a part of current collector plate **120**. More specifically, laminated film **130** covers positive-electrode sheets **111**, negative-electrode sheets **112**, separators **113**, a part of positive-electrode current collector plate **120p**, and a part of negative-electrode current collector plate **120n**. Laminated film **130** is filled with an electrolyte solution (not shown).

(21) Adhesive member **140** is a member that bonds laminated film **130** to each current collector plate **120p**, **120n**. Adhesive member **140** is made of an insulating material (such as a resin). Adhesive member **140** is shaped to protrude from laminated film **130**. Specially, adhesive member **140** covers a part of positive-electrode protrusion **121** and a part of negative-electrode protrusion **122**.

(22) Bus bar **102** connects positive-electrode protrusion **121** and negative-electrode protrusion **122** that face each other such that power storage cells **101** are electrically connected in series. Bus bar **102** includes a positive-electrode contact portion **102a**, a negative-electrode contact portion **102b**, and a coupling portion **102c**.

(23) Positive-electrode contact portion **102a** is shaped into a flat plate. Positive-electrode contact portion **102a** is in surface contact with positive-electrode protrusion **121**. Positive-electrode contact portion **102a** is welded to positive-electrode protrusion **121**.

(24) Negative-electrode contact portion **102b** is shaped into a flat plate. Negative-electrode contact portion **102b** is in surface contact with negative-electrode protrusion **122**. Negative-electrode contact portion **102b** is welded to negative-electrode protrusion **122**.

(25) Coupling portion **102c** couples positive-electrode contact portion **102a** to negative-electrode contact portion **102b**. Coupling portion **102c** is shaped to extend in one direction (a direction in which positive-electrode protrusion **121** and negative-electrode protrusion **122** face each other). In

the present embodiment, coupling portion **102c** couples an inner end of positive-electrode contact portion **102a** in the orthogonal direction to an inner end of negative-electrode contact portion **102b** in the orthogonal direction. In other words, bus bar **102** is shaped to have an opening that opens outward in the orthogonal direction. This facilitates welding of positive-electrode contact portion **102a** to positive-electrode protrusion **121** and welding of negative-electrode contact portion **102b** to negative-electrode protrusion **122**, from outside of power storage module **100** in the orthogonal direction.

(26) Case **200** houses power storage module **100**. Case **200** is made of a metal (such as aluminum). Case **200** includes a case body **210** and a closing plate **220**, as shown in FIG. 1.

(27) Case body **210** has an opening that opens in at least one direction. In the present embodiment, case body **210** is shaped into a square tube having a central axis extending in a direction orthogonal to a direction of stacking of power storage cells **101**. Case body **210** is provided with an inlet **h** (see FIG. 2).

(28) Closing plate **220** is welded to case body **210** so as to close the opening of case body **210**. Closing plate **220** is shaped into a flat plate.

(29) Cooling device **20** is provided to be in contact with an outer lateral surface of case body **210**. In other words, cooling device **20** is provided to be in contact with case **200** in the direction orthogonal to the direction of stacking of power storage cells **101**.

(30) Insulating sheet **300** covers an inner surface of case body **210** and an inner surface of closing plate **220**. Insulating sheet **300** may cover an upper surface and a lower surface of case body **210**, as shown in FIG. 2.

(31) Filling portion **400** is made of an insulating material. Preferably, filling portion **400** is made of a thermally conductive material. Filling portion **400** is formed by injecting the material (in the present embodiment, a potting material) into case **200** through inlet **h** of case **200**.

(32) Filling portion **400** covers the tip of positive-electrode protrusion **121** and the tip of negative-electrode protrusion **122**, as shown in FIG. 2. Filling portion **400** entirely covers protrusion **121**, **122** together with adhesive member **140**. Filling portion **400** may cover adhesive material **140** and an end of laminated film **130**.

(33) Preferably, filling portion **400** entirely covers bus bars **102**, **13**, **14**. Preferably, filling portion **400** is in contact with insulating sheet **300** provided on the inner surface of case body **210** and insulating sheet **300** provided on the inner surface of closing plate **220**. As a result, a relative displacement of power storage module **100** to case **200** is reduced.

(34) Power storage device **10** may further include a restriction unit **500**, as shown in FIG. 2. Restriction unit **500** is placed between power storage module **100** and case body **210**. Restriction unit **500** may be placed between a pair of power storage cells **101** adjacent to each other.

(35) Restriction unit **500** restricts a relative displacement of power storage module **100** to case **200** in the direction of stacking of power storage cells **101**. Restriction unit **500** is made of, for example, a material having dilatency characteristics. Specifically, when each power storage cell **101** is displaced relative to case **200** at a low velocity in the direction of stacking, such as when each power storage cell **101** expands, restriction unit **500** elastically deforms to absorb the expansion of each power storage cell **101**. On the other hand, when each power storage cell **101** is displaced relative to case **200** at a relatively high velocity in the direction of stacking, such as when power storage device **10** vibrates, restriction unit **500** shows a relatively high modulus of elasticity to restrict a relative displacement of each power storage cell **101** to case **200**. This reduces resonance of power storage module **100** when power storage device **10** vibrates.

(36) In power storage device **10** of the present embodiment, since bus bar **102** is shaped to extend in one direction as describe above, the length of bus bar **102** in the one direction can be adjusted, thus accommodating changes in the length between positive-electrode protrusion **121** and negative-electrode protrusion **122** due to a change in the thickness of each power storage cell **101** in the direction of stacking. Consequently, a change in the thickness of each power storage cell **101** can

be accommodated while providing commonality of shape between positive-electrode current collector plate **120p** and negative-electrode current collector plate **120n**.

(37) In the present embodiment, current collector plate **120** and bus bar **102** are cooled by cooling device **20** via filling portion **400** made of a thermally conductive material from the lateral portion of case **200** in the direction orthogonal to the direction of stacking. Current collector plate **120** and bus bar **102** are made of metal, and accordingly, power storage module **100** is cooled effectively.

Embodiment 2

(38) Next, power storage device **10** of Embodiment 2 of the present disclosure will be described with reference to FIGS. **4** and **5**. FIG. **4** is a sectional view schematically showing a configuration of a battery pack including a power storage device of Embodiment 2 of the present disclosure. FIG. **5** is an exploded perspective view schematically showing a configuration of a power storage module in the power storage device of Embodiment 2 of the present disclosure. Embodiment 2 will describe only a difference from Embodiment 1, and will not repeat the description on the same structure, and function and effect as those of Embodiment 1.

(39) In the present embodiment, coupling portion **102c** couples an outer end of positive-electrode contact portion **102a** in the orthogonal direction to an outer end of negative-electrode contact portion **102b** in the orthogonal direction. In other words, bus bar **102** is shaped to have an opening that opens inward in the orthogonal direction. In the present embodiment, positive-electrode contact portion **102a** may be welded to any surface of positive-electrode protrusion **121**, and negative-electrode contact portion **102b** may be welded to any surface of negative-electrode protrusion **122**.

(40) As shown in FIG. **5**, coupling portion **102c** of bus bar **102** is provided with a through-hole **102h**. Through through-hole **102h**, positive-electrode contact portion **102a** can be welded to positive-electrode protrusion **121** and negative-electrode contact portion **102b** can be welded to negative-electrode protrusion **122**, from outside of power storage module **100** in the orthogonal direction.

(41) In this manner, the position of coupling portion **102c** in the orthogonal direction is outside of that of Embodiment 1 in the orthogonal direction, leading to a smaller amount of the material (potting material) required for formation of filling portion **400** that is in contact with coupling portion **102c**. As filling portion **400** is in contact with coupling portion **102c**, a contact area between filling portion **400** and bus bar **102** increases, thereby increasing the efficiency of cooling each power storage cell **101**.

Embodiment 3

(42) Power storage device **10** of Embodiment 3 of the present disclosure will be described below with reference to FIG. **6**. FIG. **6** is a sectional view schematically showing a configuration of a battery pack including a power storage device of Embodiment 3 of the present disclosure. Embodiment 3 will describe only a difference from Embodiment 1, and will not repeat the description on the same structure, and function and effect as those of Embodiment 1.

(43) In the present embodiment, positive-electrode protrusion **121** includes a positive-electrode projection **121a** and a positive-electrode bent portion **121b**, and negative-electrode protrusion **122** includes a negative-electrode projection **122a** and a negative-electrode bent portion **122b**.

(44) Positive-electrode projection **121a** is shaped to project toward one side in the orthogonal direction. Positive-electrode projection **121a** is shaped into a flat plate.

(45) Positive-electrode bent portion **121b** is shaped to extend from an outer end of positive-electrode projection **121a** in the orthogonal direction toward one side in the one direction. Positive-electrode bent portion **121b** is shaped into a flat plate. Positive-electrode bent portion **121b** is orthogonal to positive-electrode projection **121a**.

(46) Negative-electrode projection **122a** is shaped to project to the other side in the orthogonal direction. Negative-electrode projection **122a** is shaped into a flat plate.

(47) Negative-electrode bent portion **122b** is shaped to extend from an outer end of negative-

electrode projection **122a** in the orthogonal direction toward the other side in the one direction. In other words, negative-electrode bent portion **122b** extends from negative-electrode projection **122a** in the direction opposite to the direction in which positive-electrode bent portion **121b** extends from positive-electrode projection **121a**. Thus, negative-electrode bent portion **122b** in one power storage cell **101** faces, in the one direction, positive-electrode bent portion **121b** in a power storage cell **101** adjacent to the one power storage cell **101**. Negative-electrode bent portion **122b** is shaped into a flat plate. Negative-electrode bent portion **122b** is orthogonal to negative-electrode projection **122a**.

(48) Bus bar **102** is shaped into a flat plate. Bus bar **102** connects positive-electrode bent portion **121b** to negative-electrode bent portion **122b** with being in surface contact with both of positive-electrode bent portion **121b** and negative-electrode bent portion **122b**. Bus bar **102** is in contact with the inner lateral surface of each bent portion **121b**, **122b** in the orthogonal direction. Bus bar **102** is welded to positive-electrode bent portion **121b** and negative-electrode bent portion **122b**.

(49) In Embodiment 3, bus bar **102** may be in contact with the outer lateral surface of each bent portion **121b**, **122b** in the orthogonal direction.

(50) It will be appreciated by a person skilled in the art that the exemplary embodiments described above provide specific examples of the following aspects.

(51) A power storage device in the embodiment described above includes a plurality of power storage cells stacked in one direction, and a bus bar that electrically connects power storage cells of the plurality of power storage cells to each other. Each of the power storage cells includes a plurality of positive-electrode sheets stacked in the one direction, a plurality of negative-electrode sheets stacked in the one direction, a positive-electrode current collector plate connected to the plurality of positive-electrode sheets, a negative-electrode current collector plate connected to the plurality of negative-electrode sheets, and a laminated film covering the plurality of positive-electrode sheets, the plurality of negative-electrode sheets, a part of the positive-electrode current collector plate, and a part of the negative-electrode current collector plate. The positive-electrode current collector plate includes a positive-electrode protrusion shaped to protrude from the laminated film in an orthogonal direction orthogonal to the one direction. The negative-electrode current collector plate includes a negative-electrode protrusion shaped to protrude from the laminated film in the orthogonal direction. The plurality of power storage cells are stacked such that the positive-electrode protrusion in one power storage cell among the plurality of power storage cells and the negative-electrode protrusion in another power storage cell adjacent to the one power storage cell among the plurality of power storage cells face each other in the one direction. The bus bar is shaped to extend in the one direction and connects the positive-electrode protrusion to the negative-electrode protrusion.

(52) In this power storage device, since the bus bar is shaped to extend in one direction, the length of the bus bar in the one direction can be adjusted, thus accommodating changes in the length between the positive-electrode protrusion and the negative-electrode protrusion due to the change in the thickness of each power storage cell in the direction of stacking. Thus, the change in the thickness of each power storage cell can be accommodated while providing commonality of shape among the positive-electrode current collector plate and the negative-electrode current collector plate.

(53) The positive-electrode protrusion and the negative-electrode protrusion may be each shaped into a flat plate orthogonal to the one direction. The bus bar may include a positive-electrode contact portion that is in surface contact with the positive-electrode protrusion, a negative-electrode contact portion that is in surface contact with the negative-electrode protrusion, and a coupling portion shaped to extend in the one direction and coupling the positive-electrode contact portion to the negative-electrode contact portion.

(54) In this case, the coupling portion may couple an inner end of the positive-electrode contact portion in the orthogonal direction to an inner end of the negative-electrode contact portion in the

orthogonal direction.

(55) The positive-electrode protrusion may include a positive-electrode projection projecting in the orthogonal direction, and a positive-electrode bent portion shaped to extend from an outer end of the positive-electrode projection in the orthogonal direction toward one side in the one direction. The negative-electrode protrusion may include a negative-electrode projection projecting in the orthogonal direction, and a negative-electrode bent portion shaped to extend from an outer end of the negative-electrode projection in the orthogonal direction toward an another side in the one direction. The bus bar may be shaped into a flat plate and connect the positive-electrode bent portion to the negative-electrode bent portion while being in surface contact with both of the positive-electrode bent portion and the negative-electrode bent portion.

(56) Although the present disclosure has been described and illustrated in detail, it is clearly understood that the same is by way of illustration and example only and is not to be taken by way of limitation, the scope of the present disclosure being interpreted by the terms of the appended claims.

Claims

1. A battery pack comprising: a power storage device; a cooling device, wherein the power storage device includes: a plurality of power storage cells stacked in one direction; a case made of a metal and housing the plurality of power storage cells; a filling portion made of an insulating and a thermally conductive material and filled in the case; and a bus bar that electrically connects power storage cells of the plurality of power storage cells to each other, wherein each of the power storage cells includes: a plurality of positive-electrode sheets stacked in the one direction, a plurality of negative-electrode sheets stacked in the one direction, a positive-electrode current collector plate connected to the plurality of positive-electrode sheets, a negative-electrode current collector plate connected to the plurality of negative-electrode sheets, and a laminated film covering the plurality of positive-electrode sheets, the plurality of negative-electrode sheets, a part of the positive-electrode current collector plate, and a part of the negative-electrode current collector plate, the positive-electrode current collector plate includes a positive-electrode protrusion shaped to protrude from the laminated film in an orthogonal direction orthogonal to the one direction, the negative-electrode current collector plate includes a negative-electrode protrusion shaped to protrude from the laminated film in the orthogonal direction, the plurality of power storage cells are stacked such that the positive-electrode protrusion in one power storage cell among the plurality of power storage cells and the negative-electrode protrusion in another power storage cell adjacent to the one power storage cell among the plurality of power storage cells face each other in the one direction, and the bus bar is shaped to extend in the one direction and connects the positive-electrode protrusion to the negative-electrode protrusion, the positive-electrode protrusion and the negative-electrode protrusion are each shaped into a flat plate orthogonal to the one direction, and the bus bar includes a positive-electrode contact portion that is in surface contact with the positive-electrode protrusion, a negative-electrode contact portion that is in surface contact with the negative-electrode protrusion, and a coupling portion shaped to extend in the one direction and couple an outer end of the positive-electrode contact portion to an outer end of the negative-electrode contact portion in the orthogonal direction, wherein the coupling portion includes a plurality of through-holes spaced apart and arranged at intervals in a direction orthogonal to both the one direction and the orthogonal direction, wherein the case has an opposing wall with an inner surface that faces an outer surface of the coupling portion in the orthogonal direction, wherein the cooling device is in contact with an outer surface of the opposing wall, and wherein the filling portion is in direct contact with each of: the positive-electrode protrusion, the negative-electrode protrusion, the positive-electrode contact portion, the negative-electrode contact portion, an inner

surface and the outer surface of the coupling portion in the orthogonal direction, and an insulating sheet provided on the inner surface of the opposing wall of the case.
